

SMARTPHONES

MANAS SINGH, 33
TV presenter and YouTuber

Mumbai

What he bought: **iPhone 14 in October 2023**

What he paid: **₹70,000 plus**

As somebody who regularly uploads live videos on 'Menace & the Monk', a YouTube channel he runs with friend Nidhi Shankar, he wanted a phone with a superior camera that could help him shoot better-quality videos. He chose the 256 GB variant of the iPhone 14, which allowed him to shoot more videos and store them. He had to spend upwards of ₹70,000, compared to the ₹20,000 he spent on his earlier Android phone from Oppo, but the decision paid off. "The quality of video I get now is brilliant," he says.

South Asia, at Diageo, "is by observing how Indian consumers access the same trademark at different price points." She is talking about alcohol, where the organised liquor industry will see its revenue grow by 12-13 per cent this fiscal to about Rs 4.45 lakh crore, going by a CRISIL Ratings report. Director Rahul Guha says consumers are transitioning from country liquor to branded liquor and, within the branded segment, opting for higher-priced bottles. That growth has come in categories beyond whisky and beer—in vodka, gin, wine, etc.—albeit from a smaller base. The premium segment, which is over Rs 1,000 for a 750 ml bottle, is expected to grow at over 20 per cent, again on a lower base. For Diageo, the prestige and above segment, which includes Blue Label, Double Black and others, recorded double-digit growth of 12.8 per cent year-on-year. "Traditionally, individuals would commence their Scotch whisky journey with a Red Label," says Jain. "But now we are witnessing an increasing number of younger people opting for premium variants." The younger consumer is also becoming more adventurous with her choice of liquor. Her parents may have stuck to one brand of whisky for life, but she could be exploring seven different brands on different occasions in three months, Jain adds. To diversify its portfolio, Diageo launched its global tequila brand, Don Julio, in the Indian market last year.

DURABLES: GOING FOR BIGGER, BETTER

Nowhere has the trend of premiumisation been more pronounced than in the consumer durables segment. The pandemic years, when people were forced to do their own chores during lockdowns, saw this phenomenon gather pace, as they invested in appliances that could make their lives easier, says Kamal Nandi, business head and executive vice-president, Godrej Appliances. Top-loading washing machines, dishwashers or frost-free refrigerators, glass screen televisions or inverter air conditioners, retailers reported a surge in sales across all regions.

The demand has sustained since then. First-time buyers, young working couples, says Nandi, are driving this demand in consumer durables, directly buying high-end variants. Gurugram-based pastry chef Shubhi Kumar, 26, and road repair business owner Archit Uppal, 31, typify this consumer. The couple, who got married in December, invested in a chimney, dishwasher, hob, workstation sink—all from Bosch—in their home. "We love to cook and host parties. We were very conscious that our open kitchen needed to be not just functional but also aesthetically pleasing as all the appliances would be visible to our guests" says Shubhi. She opted for a built-in dishwasher that could seamlessly merge with the cabinet laminates. Buying products from a single brand also gave the kitchen a cohesive look, as well as better bargains from the dealer, she adds.



SHUVADIP BANERJEE
Chief Digital Marketing Officer, ITC Foods

"THE SAME CONSUMER MAY WANT PURE-PLAY NUTRITION WHEN IN HEALTH MODE AND PURE-PLAY INDULGENCE WHEN TREATING THEMSELVES"